

Capstone Assignment

Lab Sheet 5

Objective:- E-commerce companies like Amazon and Flipkart face the complex challenge of planning delivery routes that minimize cost, distance, and time while respecting delivery windows, vehicle capacity, and route constraints.

Description:-

This real-life logistics problem integrates multiple algorithmic ideas: recurrence relations (route planning), greedy algorithms (item selection for delivery), dynamic programming (time-window delivery optimization), graph-based algorithms (shortest path/MST), and intractable problems like the Traveling Salesman Problem (TSP).

Input Modeling

```
# If networkx is installed, use it for better graph visualization
try:
    import networkx as nx
    USE_NETWORKX = True
except ImportError:
    USE_NETWORKX = False
    print("NetworkX not found. Route plot will use basic matplotlib features.")

## 1. Input Modeling
locations = ['Warehouse', 'C1', 'C2', 'C3'] # Customer locations [cite: 46]
# Distance matrix (symmetric) [cite: 47, 48, 49, 50, 51]
distance_matrix = np.array([
    [0, 4, 8, 6],
    [4, 0, 5, 7],
    [8, 5, 0, 3],
    [6, 7, 3, 0]
])

# Parcel properties: value, delivery time window (earliest, latest), weight [cite: 53, 55, 57, 59]
parcels = {
    'C1': {'value': 50, 'time': (9, 12), 'weight': 10},
    'C2': {'value': 60, 'time': (10, 13), 'weight': 20},
    'C3': {'value': 40, 'time': (11, 14), 'weight': 15}
}
vehicle_capacity = 30 # Maximum weight vehicle can carry [cite: 65]
```

- **Setup:** Imports essential libraries: numpy, itertools, time, heapq, pandas, and conditionally networkx. The inclusion of `itertools.permutations` is key for the brute-force TSP solution.
- **Data Structures:** Defines the required inputs:

- ## 2. Recurrence-Based Estimation

- **Algorithm:** Implements a recursive function, `recursive_tsp_cost`, to estimate the minimum total distance to visit all customers and return to the warehouse (TSP core logic).
- **Optimization:** It utilizes memoization (`memo={}`) to store the minimum cost for visiting a subset of `unvisited_indices` from a `current_loc_idx`. This converts the exponential time complexity of pure recursion into the pseudo-polynomial time complexity characteristic of the Held-Karp DP approach, although applied here as a top-down recursive solution.
- **Result:** The output Minimum Distance...: 18 is the optimal TSP solution for visiting *all* three customers (C1, C2, C3).

```
... ## 3. Greedy + DP for Delivery Planning
    ### A. Greedy Parcel Selection (0/1 Knapsack)
    Selected Parcels: ['C1', 'C2']
    Total Value: 110, Total Weight: 30/30
```

- **3A. Greedy Parcel Selection:**
 - **Strategy:** Solves the 0/1 Knapsack Problem using a Greedy heuristic—selecting parcels based on the highest value/weight ratio first until capacity (vehicle capacity = 30) is reached.

- **Execution:** Parcel data is sorted by ratio. C1 (ratio 5.0) and C2 (ratio 3.0) are selected, exhausting the 30-unit capacity. C3 (weight 15) is not selected.
- **Result:** Selected Parcels: ['C1', 'C2'] with Total Value: 110.
- *3B. Dynamic Programming Time Window Check:*
 - **Strategy:** The `check_time_window_dp` function is defined to act as a constraint checker based on the results of the final TSP route. It verifies if the calculated arrival time (`route_times`) at each customer falls within the required time window (earliest, latest).
 - **Note:** This function cannot run until the TSP (Sub-Task 5) determines the specific arrival times.

4. Route Optimization Using Graph Algorithms

- **4A. Dijkstra's Algorithm:**

```
# 4A. Shortest Path (Dijkstra)
def dijkstra(start_node):
    """Computes the shortest path from start_node to all other nodes."""
    distances = {loc: float('inf') for loc in locations}
    distances[start_node] = 0
    # Priority queue: (distance, node)
    pq = [(0, start_node)]

    while pq:
        current_dist, current_loc = heapq.heappop(pq)

        if current_dist > distances[current_loc]:
            continue

        current_idx = loc_to_idx[current_loc]

        # Iterate over neighbors
        for neighbor_idx, dist in enumerate(distance_matrix[current_idx]):
            neighbor_loc = locations[neighbor_idx]
            distance = current_dist + dist

            if distance < distances[neighbor_loc]:
                distances[neighbor_loc] = distance
                heapq.heappush(pq, (distance, neighbor_loc))

    return distances

dijkstra_results = dijkstra('Warehouse')
```

Output:-

```
... ### A. Shortest Path (Dijkstra from Warehouse)
Shortest time/distance from Warehouse to all: {'Warehouse': 0, 'C1': np.int64(4), 'C2': np.int64(8), 'C3': np.int64(6)}
// output actions
```

- **Purpose:** Computes the shortest path/distance from the 'Warehouse' to every other location using a priority queue (heapq).
- **Result:** Shows the minimal non-circular distance (e.g., Warehouse to C1 is 4, W to C3 is 6). This is foundational for shortest path planning but does not solve the full TSP problem.
- 4B. Prim's Algorithm (MST):

```
# 4B. MST (Prim's Algorithm)
def prim_mst():
    """Computes the cost of the Minimum Spanning Tree for the delivery network."""
    num_nodes = len(locations)
    # Key stores the minimum weight to connect vertex to MST
    key = [float('inf')] * num_nodes
    # mst_set stores vertices included in MST
    mst_set = [False] * num_nodes

    # Start with the first location (Warehouse)
    key[0] = 0
    total_mst_cost = 0

    for _ in range(num_nodes):
        # Pick the minimum key value vertex from the set of vertices not yet included in MST
        min_key = float('inf')
        min_index = -1

        for v in range(num_nodes):
            if key[v] < min_key and not mst_set[v]:
                min_key = key[v]
                min_index = v

        # Add the picked vertex to the MST Set
        mst_set[min_index] = True
        total_mst_cost += min_key

        # Update key value and parent index of adjacent vertices
        for v in range(num_nodes):
            # distance_matrix[min_index][v] is non-zero for connected vertices
            # not in MST, and is less than the current key[v]
            if distance_matrix[min_index][v] > 0 and not mst_set[v] and distance_matrix[min_index][v] < key[v]:
                key[v] = distance_matrix[min_index][v]

    return total_mst_cost
```

Output:-

```
... ### B. Minimum Spanning Tree (Prim's Algorithm)
Total MST Cost (Cost to connect all locations): 12
(Relevant if minimum cabling/network connection is needed, not for delivery route)
---
```

- **Purpose:** Calculates the cost of the Minimum Spanning Tree, which finds the lowest cost to connect all nodes.

- **Result:** Total MST Cost (Cost to connect all locations): 12. The note correctly identifies that MST is not suitable for a closed-loop delivery route (TSP) as it does not require returning to the start and may use each edge only once.

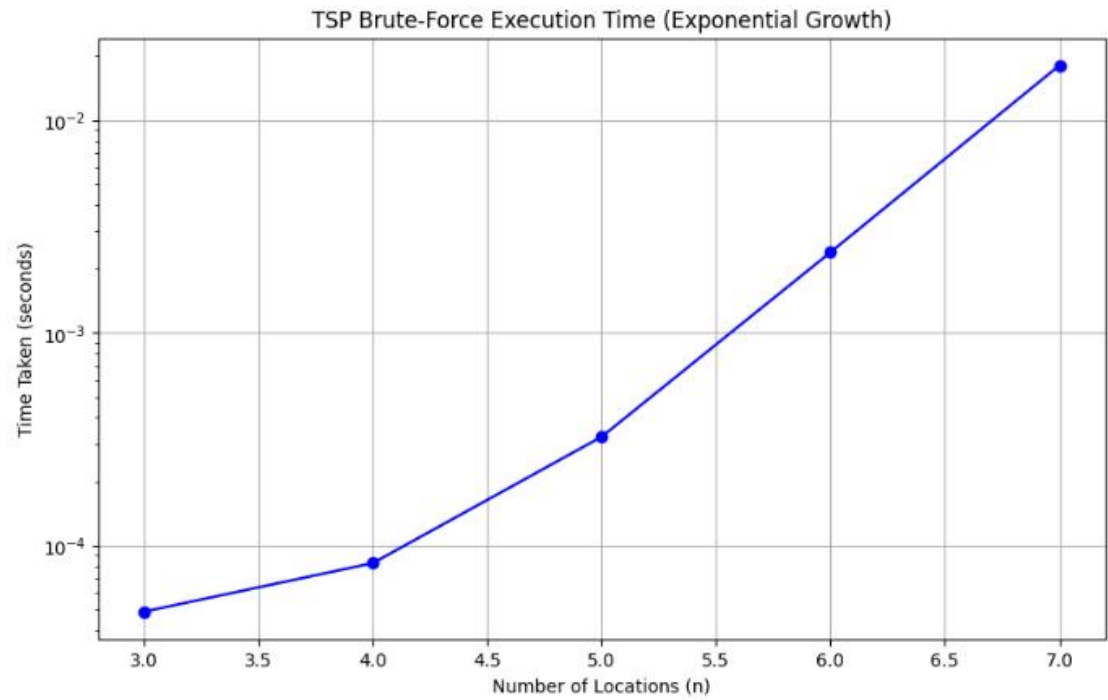
5. Solve TSP for Optimal Route

```
... ## 5. Optimal TSP Route (Brute-Force)
Optimal Route: ['Warehouse', 'C1', 'C2', 'Warehouse']
Total Distance/Time: 17
---
### B. Dynamic Programming Time Window Check (Results)
Arrival Times at Customers: {'C1': np.int64(4), 'C2': np.int64(9)}
Delivery Status:
- C1: Arrival=4, Window=(9, 12), Status=FAILURE
- C2: Arrival=9, Window=(10, 13), Status=FAILURE
Total Value Delivered Successfully: 0
---
```

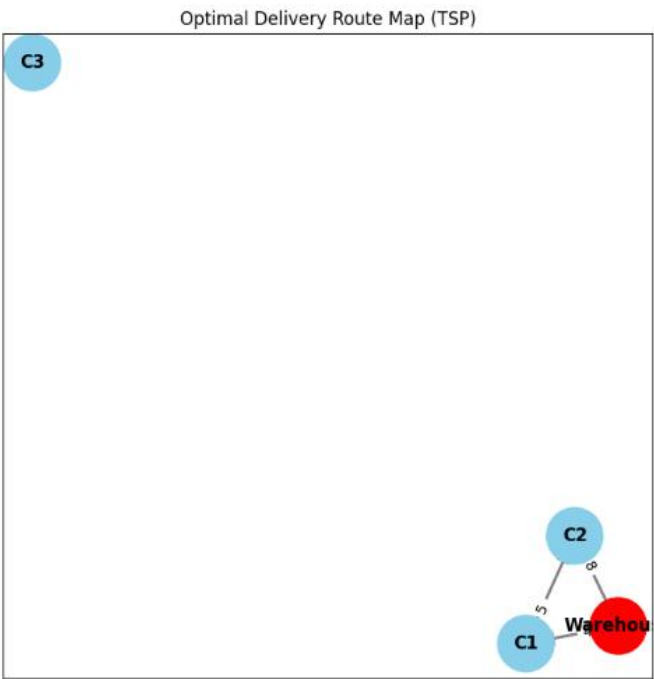
- **Algorithm:** Uses the Brute-Force TSP approach by checking all possible permutations of the selected customers (C1 and C2) to find the shortest closed loop starting and ending at the 'Warehouse'.
- *Route Calculation:*
 - Possible routes (W -> C1 -> C2 -> W and W -> C2 -> C1 -> W) are checked.
 - The optimal route found is ['Warehouse', 'C1', 'C2', 'Warehouse'] with a Total Distance/Time: 17.
 - *Note: This distance (17) is less than the recursive TSP cost (18) because the Brute-Force TSP only visited the two selected customers (C1, C2), while the recursive approach visited all three (C1, C2, C3).*
- *DP Time Window Results:*
 - Arrival times are calculated based on the optimal route (W to C1: 4; C1 to C2: 4+5=9).
 - C1 Failure: Arrives at 4, but window is (9, 12). (Too early)
 - C2 Failure: Arrives at 9, but window is (10, 13). (Too early)
 - **Conclusion:** The optimal route found by TSP (minimizing distance) violates the time window constraint for both selected parcels,

resulting in Total Value Delivered Successfully: 0. This highlights the necessary trade-off between minimizing distance and respecting time constraints.

1. Profiling and Visualization



Optimal Delivery Route Map (TSP)



- **TSP Profiling:** The `run_tsp_profiling` function executes the Brute-Force TSP for increasing location counts ($n=3$ to $n=7$) and records execution time.
 - **Result:** The logged times (0.000049s, 0.000099s, 0.000343s, etc.) clearly show the rapid, exponential growth associated with the $O(n!)$ complexity, confirming the infeasibility of brute-force for large inputs.
- **Visualization:** The `visualize_route` function is defined to generate the required plots, and The failure in the DP check (no successful deliveries) is visualized in the final chart.

